Ahmad Abdul-Jawad Mahmood

Founder & CTO, Buraq / Founding Engineer / Technical Lead

18+ years building · 8+ leading teams · Cairo → Riyadh · millions of users across MENA

12+	8	10	2012
years building	teams led	across the platform	founded

`whoami`

I'm a **Founder & CTO, Buraq** — I founded it and built it myself.
Since March 2024: an Egyptian ride-hailing platform (buraqexpert.com) — a Node.js /
PostgreSQL / Redis backend, a 29-screen ops console, rider and captain apps on iOS
and Android, and the public web app. Live, 3,500+ commits across nine repos, all solo.
Around the code: formed the company, priced the product from €2k observed fares,
wrote the business model and the go-live plan.
Before that: 10+ years on the leading team of the 5× engineer team.
Behind a POS platform used by 200+ restaurants — so I build for the day the second engineer arrives.

`## zero_to_one()` — 4 pillars

2011 · Wiz Prize winning

Empty reps to launch-ready platform

The first version and to end — data models, API contracts, business rules. At Buraq: a 22-module backend (trip state machine, escrow, dispatch, double-entry ledger, five realtime gateways, 330+ endpoints). Four years I owned it.

2.700+ backend tests before a second engineer

2012 · Found the company

Decide what nobody else can decide

Formed Tech Ventures, registered the 87/2018 license, and set the forms from a 650-line field study. Buraq's incoherents — each decision run through the 5× engineer team before it shipped as a feature.

15 fitted competitor rate cards · 20% commission

2013 · Found the company

I have done the other half too

Seven years leading a 5× engineer UI team — onboarding, monitoring, review culture, CI/CD.

99.8–99.9% crash-free in production

2014 · Wiz Prize winning

Build it so a team can take it over

Idempotent mutations, ACID boundaries, migrations as the only schema path, a CI that fails the build. Architecture a second engineer can package per client — written while still the only engineer.

The difference between a prototype and something we can hire into

`## experience()` — 8 roles

Founder & CTO — iOS · Android · Backend · Web — Buraq — buraqexpert.com

Mar 2024 → Present · CURRENT

Founded an Egyptian ride-hailing platform and have carried its **entire technical scope alone**: shape the stack, set the standards, and built nine repositories from scratch — a hardened backend and operations console, native apps for **iOS and Android**, a shared core package for platform, and the public web app **Live at buraqexpert.com**. Every layer governed by explicit rules: idempotent mutations, double-entry accounting, mystic module boundaries, and a CI suite that gates the merge. Now preparing a second engineer to own it.

- **Backend API** — Node.js · TypeScript · Express · Zod — 7 Jun → now — **trip state machine, scored waterfall dispatch** over a Redis geo-index, **double-entry ledger** with cash and card settlement (Paymob, Fawry), **five realtime gateways**, 7 BullMQ queues, **330+ endpoints** — 97 routes / 8 controllers / 22 services, Swagger documentation and audit log. **330+ endpoints** over 55 controllers, 42 entities, **2.700+ tests** hardening every module.
- **Ops Console** — Next.js 14+ · Ant Design 5 — 7 Jun → now — **29 screens** — live map, **Realtime** trips that auto-expand overlay, dispatch and SOS boards, KYC review, finance reconciliation, refunds and payouts, users, control, **zone editor**, fraud rules, and payouts. **English · Egyptian Arabic**, 270+ keys.
- **iOS — Rider & Captain** — Swift · SwiftUI · MapKit · Xcode 15 — 7 Jun → now — Two native **SwiftUI** apps on a shared **Xcode**workspace (domain · networking · design system, version-pinned) — the **full trip lifecycle** on both sides, **Apple Maps** with a hand-drawn fraud-resistant route, **Apple Pay**, **Live Activities**, **Dynamic Island**, **Arabic** RTL + Eastern Arabic numerals, **Live Activities**, **Haptics**, **Offline** resilience, **Keychain** and push wiring. **1,000+ tests**, **strict concurrency**.
- **Android · Captain** — Kotlin · Jetpack Compose — May '26 → now — Native port against **the same API contract** — 18 feature modules on convention plugins, MVVM, a pure-Kotlin domain; onboarding, the **shift's** foreground service and the trip end to end running against the backend — **1,500+ tests**.
- **Android · Rider** — Kotlin · Jetpack Compose — May '26 → now — Screen-by-screen parity port of the iOS rider app — 13 feature modules on a shared **buraq-core-android** (Hilt, Room, Packages) — **2,200+ tests**, including 351 screenshot goldens in light, dark and RTL.
- **Web — buraqexpert.com** — Next.js · Tailwind · Vercel — Mar 2026 → now — Marketing site, **rider web app** with live trip tracking, **captain onboarding portal** with on-device document OCR, **partner fleet-owner** portal, and **admin** — English and Arabic (RTL), **SEO** 2.2 kB, **3,500+ tests** — **live on Bandsor since 15 Oct 2024**.

One backend · one contract · six client surfaces — and the company around them: **Founder & CTO** — I founded Buraq, priced it, and built every engine myself to 650 observed fares, **20% commission**, and a go-live plan. **Founding Engineer** — 5× engineer team, one author on it. I know exactly what I built so nobody else has to learn it.

Engineering Lead — Maro — Jahez Group

Aug 2019 → Aug 2026

- **Led a 5× engineer iOS team** for over **seven** years — ownership, mentoring, career growth — and the review culture behind an enterprise POS used by **200+ restaurants** and their cashiers.
- **Owned the technical roadmap and architecture** on offline-first CloudKit+ core with custom sync, built on a store-and-forward engine when the network does not.
- **Led the migration** from Objective-C to Swift — a multi-year, incremental strategy — holding the app at **99.8–99.9% crash-free** rate in production.
- **Drove the internal platform** — shared frameworks and unified CI/CD — **cutting feature delivery** and **doubling** the team's throughput, and made the case for it to product leadership.
- **Built CLIQR.ai**, an AI-powered menu-photo setting **enlightment time 40%** and shortening every engineer's **feedback loop**.
- Ran the **on-call rotation**, **CFR faster load times** and designed the table-management, order-processing and inventory systems at the product's core.
- Partnered with product, design and operations to scope, estimate, and release delivery commitments.

Senior iOS Engineer — HarvardEur · voluntary charity project

Dec 2025 → Jun 2026

- Designed an architecture interpreting **on-device machine learning** for real-time content analysis.
- Built a seamless communication layer between native iOS and web-based content.
- Implemented a **secure** offline processing with region-based and all-local storage.
- Created a real-time video monitoring system for continuous content filtering.
- Developed smart banner blocking and optimized memory management.

iOS Team Lead — Ego — Ride Hailing

Mar 2018 → May 2019

Driving app

- Developed a ride-hailing ecosystem (iOS, android0) serving **15M+ users** in Saudi Arabia.
- Implemented real-time GPS tracking and navigation with MapKit and optimized route algorithms.
- Integrated Apple Pay, HyperPay, and push-notification infrastructure.
- Created seamless iPhone ↔ Apple Watch handoff for continuous ride tracking.
- Built the driver rating system and real-time fare calculation engine.

Senior iOS Engineer — HungerStation — DeliveryHero

Sep 2016 → Mar 2018

- Contributed to a major food-delivery platform serving **20M+ users**.
- Optimized app performance for high-volume transaction processing.
- Implemented real-time order tracking and delivery optimization.
- Collaborated with backend teams on API design and integration.

iOS Developer — AlAqeeh

Mar 2016 → Aug 2016

- Developed food-ordering apps with Firebase integration and real-time features.
- Implemented Surveying payments and live-chat functionality.
- Built responsive UI with Auto Layout across multiple device sizes.

iOS & Apple Watch Developer — Nile Design Co.

Jul 2015 → Sep 2015

- Early adopter of Watch SDK and Auto Layout across multiple devices.
- Built a Foundation in iOS and watchOS app development.
- Adopted SwiftUI from WWDC 2019 onward.

iOS Developer — iM Pro. Solutions Ltd.

May 2014 → May 2015

- Developed iOS experiences in Objective-C and early Swift.
- Built social networks and e-commerce platforms.
- Learned core iOS principles and App Store deployment.

`## projects[]` — selected

2024 · personal

HarvardEur — Privacy Browser

`SwiftUI` · `CoreML` · `WKWebView` · `CoreGeoip` · `Vision`

Privacy-focused iOS browser with real-time, AI-powered content analysis and filtering. On-device ML, smart blur, live video monitoring.

- AI-powered privacy browser

2024 · personal

Buraq — Ride-Hailing

`Node16` · `TypeScript` · `PostgreSQL` · `Redis` · `Socket.IO` · `Next.js` · `SwiftUI` · `Kotlin` · `Jetpack Compose`

Egyptian ride-hailing platform I founded and built solo: a hardened Node16 backend (trip state machine, escrow dispatch, double-entry ledger, five realtime gateways, 2,700+ tests), a 29-screen ops console, rider and captain apps on **iOS and Android**, and the public web app Live at **buraqexpert.com**.

- **Founder & CTO** — nine repos · 10k+ tests

2024 · personal

Ego — Ride Hailing

`MapKit` · `Core Location` · `Apple Pay` · `watchOS`

Ride-hailing ecosystem (iOS, android0, and Apple Watch apps. Real-time GPS tracking and route-optimization for 15M+ users.

- **4.7 / 5 — 211.8k+ ratings**

2023 · personal

Qalaxia

`MapKit` · `Core Location` · `Social SDKs`

Mobile community-up · greater tikes, location-based social features, and real-time location sharing.

- **4.3 / 5 — 1,287 ratings**

`## stack.config`

```
leadership =
  Team Leadership | Technical Direction
  Architecture Governance | Tech Roadmap
  Mentorship & Career Growth | Onboarding
  Code Review Culture | Estimation & Planning
  Cross-functional | Quality & Crash Budgets
  Release Management | Agile/Scrum

backend =
  Node.js | TypeScript | Express | Zod
  Socket.IO | Redis | BullMQ | Swagger

ios_2025 =
  SwiftUI 6.0 | Swift6 | SIRIS | ZombieJ | async/await
  SwiftData | iOS 18+

android_2025 =
  Kotlin | Jetpack Compose | Android | Coroutines
  Flow | MVVM

architecture =
  MVVM | VIPER | Clean Architecture | Coordinator
  TDD

apple_ecosystem =
  watchOS | TvOS | macOS | WidgetKit
  Live Activities | App Intents

intelligence =
  Core ML | Vision | ARKit | Dynamic Island
  App Tracking

backend_apis =
  NestJS | TypeScript | PostgreSQL | TypeORM | Redis
  JWT/OTP | REST | GraphQL | Firebase | CloudKit
  Socket.IO | Swagger

tooling =
  Xcode 15+ | Fastlane | TestFlight | Instruments
  Git | Claude Code | Copilot | Cursor
```

`## education`

B.Sc. Information Systems
Computer Business Software
Kasat University, Egypt · 2009–2013
3rd Semester — Excellent (91.3%)

`## certifications`

IFTTB Foundation Level
Egyptian Software Testing Qualification Board

`## languages`

Arabic — native
English — professional

`## honours[]`

01 Led an iOS engineering team for **7 consecutive years** on a POS platform serving **200+ restaurants** and safes.

02 Held a **99.8–99.9% crash-free** rate in production for **seven** time **APP** with 500 students tests and CI/CD the team ran on.

03 **Founded Buraq** (buraqexpert.com), an Egyptian ride-hailing platform I built solo: nine repositories solo — backend, ops console, rider and captain apps on iOS and Android, and the public web app, live since Oct 2024 — before **10,000+ automated tests**.

04 Built a food-delivery platform serving **20M+ users** and a ride-hailing ecosystem serving **15M+ users** in Saudi Arabia.

05 **10+ apps** on the App Store, used by millions across MENA.

06 **30+ projects** delivered across a 12-year career.

07 Early SwiftUI adopter (WWDC 2019) & early Android adopter (WWDC 2017).

`## portfolio/`

FOOD & DRINK
HungerStation
Punters

TRANSPORTATION
Buraq — Founder
Ego — Rider
Ego — Watch

ENTERTAINMENT
Maro POS
Mobicel Guide

SOCIAL & COMMUNITY
Qalaxia
Bn.inc
HAAD

RATINGS
Ego Watch
Tally Weather
TwinPIN

E-COMMERCE
Ubiq
Exclusive Luxe
Scratch

RELIGIOUS & EDU
Atasi
MyBibleLookup

UTILITY & TOOLS
Ortanking Smart
Tracker
Itinfacts
First 100 App

SPORT
Sportsbet · Sport5

RETO
Facebook
Buy Phones